

HIGH-TECH FARMING

Jalandhar | PUNJAB



A Punjabi entrepreneur transforms his farming operation into an organised technology-driven enterprise

GREEN FIELDS:
Sangha at one of his farms

■ By Ramesh Vinayak

His dapper demeanour and luxe lifestyle don't fit the stereotype of a dirt farmer. Yet, 39-year-old Jang Bahadur Singh Sangha is the poster boy for agricultural entrepreneurship. With over 6,000 acres under cultivation, Sangha runs a technology-driven operation of a scale and specialisation that even big-tag corporate farming projects are yet to achieve. With an annual production of 56,000 tonnes—ten per cent of the seed potato market—Sangha is India's single-largest seed potato grower.

The agri-empire struck roots in

The potato prince

the 1960s when his father, Hardev Singh, ventured into seed vegetable production on seven acres owned by the family near Jalandhar. Hardev then made a big investment sending Sanawar-educated Sangha to the prestigious Ivy League Cornell University in 1990 for a post-graduate degree in plant physiology and pathology. "My specialisation was programmed to introduce technology-based systems in our operations," says Sangha.

Back home in 1994, Sangha ploughed back into practice the cutting edge knowledge he had mastered abroad by setting up a well-equipped

